

Tuesday, 15 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Drizzle 20° 14°	MANCHESTER Light rain 19° 14°	GLASGOW Rain 18° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A significant constitutional debate is brewing, as leaders from Wales, Scotland, and Northern Ireland call for major changes to Westminster's power.

Plaid Cymru, the SNP, and Sinn Féin leaders are pushing for the UK government to prepare for a shift in how the country is governed. This comes as discussions around devolution and national identity continue to gain traction.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

The chief coroner for England and Wales has called for a full public inquiry into the Manchester synagogue attack.

This follows concerns that sensitive MI5 evidence might make traditional inquests unsuitable for fully investigating the tragic incident. The move highlights the complexity of dealing with national security information in legal proceedings.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A report into the sectarian murder of Robert Hamill has found no police collusion, but highlighted multiple RUC failings.

The report revealed that a tip-off was even given to a suspect in the beating that led to Mr Hamill's death in Portadown, County Armagh. This sheds light on historical police conduct during a tumultuous period.

INVESTIGATION · UK
- 4

A police officer is facing a misconduct hearing after allegedly putting a suspect in a headlock and punching him nine times.

PC Richard Williams faces eight allegations relating to an arrest. This case raises serious questions about appropriate use of force and police accountability.

POLICE · UK
- 5

Tragedy struck at the Great North Run on Sunday, as two men, both aged 25, collapsed and died on the course.

The Great Run Company confirmed the deaths, which cast a shadow over the popular event. Our thoughts are with their families and friends.

TRAGEDY · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **Oasis fans rejoice! The band have confirmed a second wave of reunion shows for 2027, including Knebworth, Manchester, and Glasgow.**

After weeks of teasers, the iconic band has added more dates to their highly anticipated comeback tour. It's fantastic news for those who missed out on tickets the first time around.

ON AIR – Are you excited for more Oasis gigs? Which city are you hoping to get tickets for?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2** **Céline Dion has made a triumphant return to the stage in Paris, kicking off her long-awaited comeback show after a six-year hiatus.**

Critics are celebrating her 'high-stakes' performance, with fans dancing, singing, and crying with joy. It's an emotional and powerful return for the beloved Canadian singer.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Céline Dion power ballad? Have you missed her on stage?

MUSIC · NOW
- 3** **Stars of the upcoming 'Practical Magic' reboot, Maisie Williams and Joey King, say people are longing for simpler times.**

The actresses feature in the sequel to the beloved 1998 fantasy romcom. It sounds like a perfect dose of comforting magic is heading our way.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Practical Magic'? What other classic films would you love to see rebooted?

FILM · COMING UP
- 4** **Harry Potter star Tom Felton is thrilled to see Rupert Grint return as Ron Weasley on Broadway.**

Felton, who is also taking on Broadway, spoke about his enduring friendships with his former co-stars. It's lovely to see the cast supporting each other's new ventures!

ON AIR – Which Harry Potter character would you most like to see on stage?

THEATRE · COMING UP
- 5** **Diljit Dosanjh has made history by headlining Wembley Stadium, becoming the first Punjabi singer to achieve this iconic feat.**

Wembley Stadium itself billed the performance as a landmark moment. It's a huge achievement and a fantastic moment for Punjabi music.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable concert you've ever seen at Wembley?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **The VAR officials involved in the controversial Manchester derby decision will not be officiating any Premier League games this weekend.**

Matt Donohue, the video assistant referee, and his assistant Blake Antrobus, have not been appointed. This follows intense scrutiny over the decision to award Erling Haaland's winner.

ON AIR – Do you think this is the right decision, or should officials be back on the pitch quickly?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Europe has clinched the Solheim Cup, with Hull and Woad delivering key performances on the final day!**

Lottie Woad sank the winning putt, securing a fantastic victory for Europe. It was a thrilling finish to a brilliant tournament.

ON AIR – Did you follow the Solheim Cup? What was your favourite moment?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

3 **Brighton delivered a stunning performance, thrashing ten-man Coventry 5-0 at home in the Premier League.**

Coventry's poor start to the season continues, with Taiwo Awoniyi sent off in the second half. It was a dominant display from Brighton.

ON AIR – What's the most surprising Premier League result you've seen this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Alexander Zverev turned his US Open tears into triumph, winning the men's singles title six years after a heartbreaking final defeat.**

A more composed and 'zen-like' Zverev beat Ben Shelton in a transformational year for the German. It's a fantastic comeback story for the tennis star.

ON AIR – What's the best sporting comeback story you can remember?

TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

5 **The problems are mounting for Manchester United and manager Michael Carrick, after just one win in their last four Premier League games.**

Familiar questions are being asked, and Carrick now faces the challenge of finding answers quickly. It's a tough start to the season for the Red Devils.

ON AIR – What do you think Manchester United needs to do to turn their season around?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful art of 'identifying interesting cloud shapes' is making a comeback as a peaceful pastime.**
Many are rediscovering the simple joy of looking up and spotting familiar objects or animals in the clouds, a charming activity that costs absolutely nothing.
- 2 A new report highlights the growing popularity of 'local park picnics' as a cost-effective and charming way to socialise.**
It seems packing a hamper and heading to a nearby green space is a top choice for friends and families looking to connect without breaking the bank.
- 3 It turns out that 'the smell of freshly baked bread' is not just delicious, it's also a top mood booster for many.**
Researchers suggest the comforting aroma can evoke feelings of warmth and nostalgia, providing a little lift to our daily routines.
- 4 The charming habit of 'leaving anonymous positive notes' in public places is spreading smiles nationwide.**
From bus stops to coffee shops, little messages of encouragement are appearing, creating unexpected moments of cheer for those who find them.
- 5 A new study reveals that the sound of distant church bells is one of Britain's most cherished calming sounds.**
Many find the gentle, rhythmic chimes incredibly soothing, associating them with peaceful village scenes and a sense of timeless tranquility.
- 6 The delightful hobby of 'creating miniature gardens' in unusual containers is blossoming across the UK.**
From teacups to old boots, tiny landscapes are popping up, showcasing creativity and a love for greenery in compact, charming ways.
- 7 Apparently, a 'perfectly ironed pillowcase' is now considered a small luxury that significantly improves sleep quality for some.**
The crispness and smooth feel are thought to contribute to a more restful night, turning a mundane chore into a moment of self-care.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET BEFORE OPENING IT, HOPING FOR A HINT OF DELICIOUSNESS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television programme, especially if it's a big series launch. What is it?

ANSWER: ENSURING ALL THE CUSHIONS ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED AND ALIGNED ON THE SOFA!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular piece of music' just instantly makes you feel better, no matter what mood you're in?

We're wondering what that one song is for you – the one that's your go-to for an instant pick-me-up or to just make things feel a bit brighter. Give us a call!

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that someone did for us once, which really stuck in our mind and made a difference, don't we?

Whether it was holding a door, letting you go first in a queue, or a kind word, what's a small act of kindness you remember receiving, and how did it make you feel? Let us know!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies use their antennae to hear sounds from long distances.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest living structure and can be seen from space.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, though they usually stick closer to the ground.
- The world's largest island is Greenland, with an area of over 2.1 million square kilometres.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- The longest river in the UK is the River Severn, flowing for approximately 220 miles.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- It is illegal to sing in public after 9 pm in Honolulu, Hawaii, if you're not singing 'The Star-Spangled Banner'.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.

On this day

Day 258 of the year, 107 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Britain Day (United Kingdom); Christian feast day: Joseph Abibos; Christian feast day: Alpinus (Albinus) of Lyon; Christian feast day: Aprus (Évre) of Toul. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Tommy Lee Jones, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1971 — Josh Charles, American actor and director
- 1981 — Ben Schwartz, American actor, comedian and writer
- 1964 — Steve Watkin, Welsh cricketer
- 1979 — Amy Davidson, American actress
- 1922 — Bob Anderson, English fencer and choreographer (died 2012)
- 1952 — Kelly Keagy, American singer and drummer
- 1977 — Sophie Dahl, English model and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 1968 — The Soviet Zond 5 spaceship is launched, becoming the first spacecraft to fly around the Moon and re-enter the Earth's atmosphere.
- 2001 — During a CART race at the Lausitzring in Germany, former Formula One driver Alex Zanardi suffers a heavy accident resulting in him losing both his legs.
- 1971 — The first Greenpeace ship departs from Vancouver to protest against the upcoming Cannikin nuclear weapon test in Alaska.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The United Nations cedes Eritrea to Ethiopia.
- 1974 — Air Vietnam Flight 706 is hijacked, then crashes while attempting to land with 75 on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1968 — The Soviet Zond 5 spaceship is launched, becoming the first spacecraft to fly around the Moon and re-enter the Earth's atmosphere.
- 2020 — Signing of the Bahrain–Israel normalization agreement occurs in Washington, D.C., normalizing relations between Israel and two Arab nations, the United Arab Emirates and Bahrain.

- 1971 — The first Greenpeace ship departs from Vancouver to protest against the upcoming Cannikin nuclear weapon test in Alaska.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 259 of the year, 106 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Curcodomus; Christian feast day: Cyprian (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Edith of Wilton; Christian feast day: Euphemia. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Sabrina Bryan, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1988 — Teddy Geiger, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1986 — Kyla Pratt, American actress and singer
- 1977 — Musiq Soulchild, American singer-songwriter
- 1969 — Justine Frischmann, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1993 — Sam Byram, English footballer
- 1942 — Bernie Calvert, English bass player and keyboard player
- 1971 — Joel Heyman, American actor, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — A 8.3 Mw earthquake strikes the Chilean city of Illapel, killing 15 people, injuring at least 34, leaving at least six missing, and causing extensive damage. One person also dies in Argentina.
- 1978 — The 7.4 Mw Tabas earthquake affects the city of Tabas, Iran with a maximum Mercalli intensity of IX (Violent). At least 15,000 people are killed.
- 2022 — The death of Mahsa Amini occurred in Tehran, Iran, sparking worldwide protests.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The first prototype of the Mikoyan MiG-31 interceptor makes its maiden flight.
- 2021 — A 6.0 Mw earthquake strikes Lu County, Sichuan, China, killing three and injuring more than 88.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar